least part-time. She eventually increased her hours to full-time after she felt enough time had passed for her children to adjust to the loss of their father.

It took six years of living with her parents before Patty could move out on her own again. These six years sometimes seemed like sixty years for both Patty and her parents. Although they loved each other, the lack of privacy and Patty's dependence on her parents had increasingly strained their relationship. When she finally moved out and gained her financial independence, Patty swore that she would never put her children into that situation again. One item that she religiously paid each month was her life insurance policy.

The tragedy of Andrew's death did not have to be followed by a financial catastrophe as well. Insurance is not something that is an option. Anyone dealing with a tragedy like Patty's is much better served by not having to also face financial burdens at the same time. An insurance payment would have solved her immediate financial needs and given her some time to plan for the future.

Words of Wisdom

Personal finance is a life skill that is rarely taught. Few young adults are exposed to personal finance instruction in school and those who are lucky enough to have instruction from their parents might not be learning the right lessons. If their parents have never learned about money, how can they be expected to be good teachers? The alternative is to continue young adult's education about money in the school of hard knocks—trial and error. This school has a very expensive tuition!

Without this proper education in personal finance, young adults find they are not equipped to handle themselves independently. Personal finance is confusing and complex. The